

Employee Handbook & HR Policies

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Applicability: All Full-Time and Part-Time Employees	Review Cycle: Annual

1. CODE OF CONDUCT & WORKPLACE ETHICS

1.1 Professionalism and Integrity

NextWave Technologies is committed to maintaining a professional, respectful, and ethical work environment. Employees are expected to conduct themselves with the highest degree of integrity when interacting with colleagues, clients, and partners.

1.2 Anti-Harassment and Non-Discrimination

Zero-Tolerance Policy: NextWave strictly prohibits discrimination or harassment of any kind based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, or veteran status.

- Reporting Mechanism:** Any employee who experiences or witnesses harassment must report it immediately to `hr@nextwavetech.local` or via the anonymous internal compliance portal.
- Investigation:** All reports are investigated within **48 business hours** of submission. Confidentiality will be maintained to the maximum extent possible.

1.3 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid any activity, investment, or relationship that creates or appears to create a conflict of interest with NextWave Technologies. Outside employment (such as freelancing, contracting, or advisory roles) must be explicitly disclosed to and approved by Department Heads and HR via the **Outside Employment Disclosure Form** prior to engagement.

2. WORK HOURS & ATTENDANCE

2.1 Core Working Hours

NextWave operates on a flexible-hybrid work model designed to balance operational efficiency and personal autonomy.

- Standard Work Week:** Monday through Friday, 40 hours per week.
- Core Collaboration Hours:** All employees must be available for synchronous communication and team collaboration between **10:00 AM and 3:00 PM EST**, regardless of their physical location or time zone.

2.2 Remote Work Policy

Employees authorized for partial or full remote work must maintain a secure, distraction-free environment equipped with a stable internet connection with a minimum benchmark speed of **50 Mbps** download.

- Company-provided assets (including corporate laptops and peripherals) must be used strictly for business operational purposes.
- Public or unencrypted Wi-Fi networks must never be utilized without activating the pre-installed corporate Virtual Private Network (VPN).

3. LEAVE & TIME-OFF BENEFITS

3.1 Paid Time Off (PTO)

Full-time employees accrue professional time off monthly, reaching standard allocations tiered relative to organizational tenure:

Employee Tenure	Annual PTO Accrual	Maximum Carryover (to next year)
Less than 2 years	20 Days	5 Days
2 to 5 years	25 Days	7 Days
5+ years	30 Days	10 Days

Approval: PTO requests exceeding three consecutive business days must be logged and requested in the internal Human Resources Management System (HRMS) at least **two weeks in advance** for proper scheduling mitigation.

3.2 Sick Leave

Employees receive **8 days of fully paid sick leave** per calendar year. A verified medical certificate from a licensed health practitioner is required for all consecutive sick absences extending beyond **3 business days**.

3.3 Parental Leave

NextWave provides up to **16 weeks of fully paid parental leave** to eligible primary and secondary caregivers following the birth of a child, or placement of a child in connection with adoption or foster care. Employees must achieve a minimum tenure milestone of 6 months to qualify for full benefits.

4. COMPENSATION & BENEFITS

4.1 Payroll Cycle

Salaries and structured compensation items are disbursed on a semi-monthly operational schedule:

- **Mid-month pay date:** 15th day of the calendar month.
- **End-of-month pay date:** Final operational business day of the calendar month.

4.2 Performance and Salary Reviews

Formal structured individual evaluations are initiated twice annually:

- **Mid-Year Review:** Individual checkpoint evaluating KPI progression (July lifecycle).
- **Annual Review:** Comprehensive operational contribution evaluation and accompanying compensation/tier adjustments (December/January lifecycle).

5. INFORMATION SECURITY & USE OF ASSETS

5.1 Data Privacy and NDAs

All active personnel remain strictly bound by the comprehensive **Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA)** validated upon initial onboarding. Proprietary platform code repositories, architectural schema diagrams, encrypted user data records, and proprietary training datasets constitute trade secrets and are strictly confidential.

5.2 Device Security Protocols

To securely safeguard corporate infrastructure integrity, employees must follow strict device compliance parameters:

- Mandatory implementation of Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) across all connected corporate accounts.
- Prohibition against transmitting raw authentication credentials, secret keys, or active API tokens over communication platforms like Slack or Discord.
- Immediate terminal locking configuration activation (`Win + L` or `Ctrl + Cmd + Q`) when vacating a designated workspace area.

6. TERMINATION & EXIT POLICY

6.1 Notice Period

- **Probationary Period (First 90 days):** 1 week written notice required by either party.
- **Permanent Status Employees:** Minimum of 4 weeks formalized written notice is mandatory upon voluntary resignation.

6.2 Return of Company Property

On or prior to the final effective date of employment, the separating individual is required to surrender all assigned company-owned infrastructure assets (including mobile devices, laptop computing rigs, structural building keys, identity tokens, and physical documentation) directly to the IT Operations cluster.

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